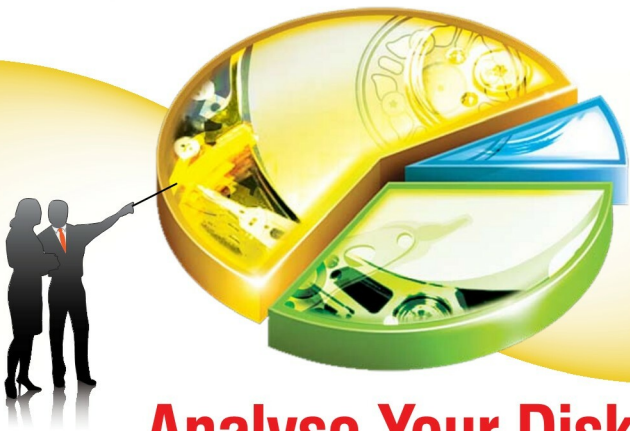




Analyse Your Disk Space Availability

A sneak peak at three handy tools—the command-line based `du` command, KDE's KDirStat and GNOME's Baobab.

*H*ard disks nowadays indeed come with lots of storage space. However, if you continuously add data without cleaning the unnecessary bits and bytes, some day you will surely run out of free space. I compile the *LFYCD*, and therefore need to download and test a lot of software. I always try to build the software from source. After a successful software installation, there is no need for the built binaries in the source directory. If I forget to clean them, after a few days, I run out of free space. So it becomes necessary for me to find a tool that eases my house-cleaning job. The *du* (disk usage) command and two GUI tools—KDirStat for KDE and Baobab for

GNOME—solve my problems.

du tells me about disk usage

Let's start with the *du* command, which summarises the disk usage of each file and directory on a disk. If you run it without any arguments, it displays the disk usage of files and subdirectories in the present working directory. Now, try the following commands instead (note that my present working directory is my desktop):

```
sandeep@linux-i7c8:~/Desktop> du -ch
4.1M  ./My Stuff/Blender 2.46 review/images
4.2M  ./My Stuff/Blender 2.46 review
5.9M  ./My Stuff/Swap/Avidemux
2.4M  ./My Stuff/Swap/SOng
```